Ans. (b): Statement 1 is incorrect:
Banks Board Bureau comprises the Chairman, three ex-officio members i.e Secretary, Department of Public Enterprises, Secretary of the Department of Financial Services and Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India, and five expert members, two of which are from the private sector. The Chairman is selected by the central government and RBI governor does not head it.
The BBB advises the Government on matters relating to appointments, confirmation or extension of tenure and termination of services of the Board of Directors in Public Sector Banks (PSBs) and financial institutions (FIs). It is responsible for the selection and appointment of Board of Directors of PSBs and FIs. So, **statement 2 is correct**.
One of the functions of the BBB is to help Public Sector Banks in terms of developing business strategies and capital raising plan etc. So, **statement 3 is correct.**

65. With reference to Convertible Bonds, consider the following statements:
1. As there is an option to exchange the bond for equity, Convertible Bonds pay a lower rate of interest.
2. The option to convert to equity affords the bondholder a degree of indexation to rising consumer prices.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Statement 1 is correct: Convertible bonds tend to offer a lower coupon rate or rate of return in exchange for the value of the option to convert the bond into common stock. Investors will generally accept a lower coupon rate on a convertible bond, compared with the coupon rate on another identical regular bond, because of its conversion feature. This enables the issuer to save on interest expenses, which can be substantial in the case of a large bond issue.
One of the advantages of convertible bonds is that the option to convert to equity affords the bondholder a degree of indexation to rising consumer prices. So, **statement 2 is correct.**

66. Consider the following:
1. Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank
2. Missile Technology Control Regime
3. Shanghai Cooperation Organisation

India is a member of which of the above?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank that aims to improve economic and social outcomes in Asia. India joined Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank on 11th January, 2016, **Option 1 is correct.**
Option 2 is correct. The Missile Technology Control Regime (MTCR) is a multilateral export control regime whose members have an informal political understanding to limit the proliferation of missiles and missile technology. India became a member of the MTCR in 2016.
The Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) is an intergovernmental organization founded in Shanghai on 15 June 2001. The SCO currently comprises eight Member States (China, India, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Pakistan, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan). India became permanent member of the SCO in 2017. So, **statement 3 is correct.**

67. Consider the following statements:
1. Vietnam has been one of the fastest growing economies in the world, in the recent years.
2. Vietnam is led by a multi-party political system
3. Vietnam's economic growth is linked to its integration with global supply chains and focus on exports.
4. For a long time Vietnam's low labour costs and stable exchange rates have attracted global manufacturers.
5. Vietnam has the most productive e-service sector in the Indo-Pacific region.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 2 and 4 (b) 3 and 5 (c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 2

Ans. (c) : According to a forecast by Pricewaterhouse Coopers in February 2017, Vietnam may be the fastest-growing economy of the world, with a potential annual GDP growth rate of about 5.1%, which would make its economy the 10th-largest in the world by 2050. Hence, Statement 1 is correct.
Vietnam is a Marxist–Leninist one-party state based on democratic centralism. Hence, Statement 2 is incorrect.
Vietnam's economic growth is linked to its integration with global supply chains and focus on exports. Hence, Statement 3 is correct.
Vietnam has low labour costs and stable exchange rates which attract global investments. Hence, Statement 4 is correct.

68. In India, which one of the following is responsible for maintaining price stability by controlling inflation?
(a) Department of Consumer Affairs
(b) Expenditure Management Commission
(c) Financial Stability and Development Council
(d) Reserve Bank of India

Ans. (d): Reserve Bank of India is India's central bank, which has key function to keep check on the inflation by use of monetary policy in forms of qualitative and quantitative measures.

69. With reference to Non-Fungible Tokens (NFTs), consider the following statements:
1. They enable the digital representation of physical assets.
2. They are unique cryptographic tokens that exist on a blockchain.
3. They can be traded or exchanged at equivalency and therefore can be used as a medium of commercial transactions.

Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): Non-fungible tokens, often referred to as NFTs, are blockchain-based tokens that each represent a unique asset like a piece of art, digital content, or media. An NFT can be thought of as an irrevocable digital certificate of ownership and authenticity for a given asset, whether digital or physical. They cannot be traded or exchanged at equivalency and therefore, cannot be used as a medium of commercial transactions.

70. Consider the following pairs:

	Reservoirs		States
1.	Ghataprabha	-	Telangana
2.	Gandhi Sagar	-	Madhya Pradesh
3.	Indira Sagar	-	Andhra Pradesh
4.	Maithon	-	Chhattisgarh

How many pairs given above are not correctly matched?
(a) Only one pair (b) Only two pairs
(c) Only three pairs (d) All four pairs

Ans. (c):

Reservoirs		States
Ghataprabha	-	Karnataka
Gandhi Sagar	–	Madhya Pradesh
Indira Sagar	–	Madhya Pradesh
Maithon	-	Jharkhand

71. In India, which one of the following compiles information on industrial disputes, closures, retrenchments and lay-offs in factories employing workers?
(a) Central Statistics Office
(b) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
(c) Labour Bureau
(d) National Technical Manpower Information System

Ans. (c): Labour Bureau is an attached office under Ministry of Labour and Employment. It was set up on 1st October 1946. It is entrusted with the work of compilation, collection, analysis and dissemination of statistics on different aspects of labour.

72. In India, what is the role of the Coal Controller's Organization (CCO)?
1. CCO is the major source of Coal Statistics in Government of India.
2. It monitors progress of development of Captive Coal/Lignite blocks.
3. It hears any objection to the Government's notification relating to acquisition of coal-bearing areas.
4. It ensures that coal mining companies deliver the coal to end users in the prescribed time.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 4

Ans. (a): The Coal Controller's Organisation (CCO) is a subordinate office of the ministry of coal, having its headquarters at Kolkata. It collects and maintains coal production data of all private and public sector coal mines in the country. Under Collection of Statistics Act, 2008, Coal Controller has been made the statistical authority with respect to coal and lignite statistics, entrusted with the responsibility of carrying out Annual Coal & Lignite survey and publishing of Provisional Coal Statistics and Coal Directory of India. It is also entrusted with the task of monitoring captive mines. Work such as permission for opening and reopening of coal mine has been entrusted to CCO.
Under Coal Bearing Area (Acquisition and Development) Act, 1957- Coal Controller is the competent authority to hear any objection to the Central Government's Notification relating to acquisition of coal bearing land and to furnish his reports to Central Government.
Ensuring that coal mining companies deliver the coal to end users in the prescribed time is not the function of Coal Controller's Organization (CCO).

73. If a particular area is brought under the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution of India, which one of the following statements best reflects the consequence of it?
(a) This would prevent the transfer of land of tribal people to non-tribal people.
(b) This would create a local self-governing body in that area.
(c) This would convert that area into a Union Territory.
(d) The State having such areas would be declared a Special Category State.

Ans. (a): The Fifth Schedule of the Constitution deals with the administration and control of Scheduled Areas as well as of Scheduled Tribes residing in any State other than the States of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.
Under the provisions of 5th scheduled of the constitution of India the Governor can make regulations which would prevent the transfer of land of tribal people to non-tribal people.

74. Consider the following statements:
1. The India Sanitation Coalition is a platform to promote sustainable sanitation and is funded by the Government of India and the World Health Organization.
2. The National Institute of Urban Affairs is an apex body of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs in Government of India and provides innovative solutions to address the challenges of Urban India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : The India Sanitation Coalition was launched on June 25, 2015, at FICCI, New Delhi. ISC is a multi-stakeholder platform that brings together the private sector, government, financial institutions, civil society groups, media, donors/bi-lateral/multilateral, experts etc. to work in the sanitation space to drive sustainable sanitation through a partnership model. It is not funded by WHO. Hence 1st statement is incorrect.
The National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA) is India's leading national think tank on urban planning and development. As a hub for the generation and dissemination of cutting-edge research in the urban sector, NIUA seeks to provide innovative solutions to address the challenges of a fast urbanizing India, and pave the way for more inclusive and sustainable cities of the future. It was established 1976 as an autonomous body under the socities Registration Act. Hence 2nd statement is correct.

75. Which one of the following has been constituted under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986?
(a) Central Water Commission
(b) Central Ground Water Board
(c) Central Ground Water Authority
(d) National Water Development Agency

Ans. (c): Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA) has been constituted under Section 3 (3) of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 to regulate and control development and management of ground water resources in the country.

76. With reference to the "United Nations Credentials Committee", consider the following statements:
1. It is a committee set up by the UN Security Council and works under its supervision.
2. It traditionally meets in March, June and September every year.
3. It assesses the credentials of all UN members before submitting a report to the General Assembly for approval.